Technological Stewardship Workshop

A Christian Conversation on AI

Duration: 45 minutes
Group Size: 10 participants
Format: In-person discussion
Prerequisite: Survey completed beforehand

Workshop Goal

Participants will:

- Engage with real, anonymized data from the group's own survey responses
- Discover biblical frameworks for thinking about AI — personally and as a church
- Share lived experiences, concerns, and convictions
- Begin forming a shared posture on AI for their church community
- Leave with **urgency** and **hope** — not fear or paralysis

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Workshop Structure

Each of the five survey sections follows this pattern:

1. **Results** — Display anonymized data from that section on screen
2. **Discussion** — Open conversation reacting to the data
3. **Bible Resources** — Scriptures that speak to this theme (participant-led first, then facilitator additions)

> **Timing is tight.** The goal is exposure and conversation, not resolution. It's okay to leave tensions unresolved.

Opening Hook (3 minutes)

Facilitator opens with a provocation:

> "By the time we finish this conversation, AI will have written 50,000 sermons, answered 2 million theological questions, and created 10,000 pieces of Christian art. Some of it good. Some of it dangerous. None of it neutral. The question isn't whether AI will shape the Church. It's whether the Church will shape AI."

Quick pulse check — go around the circle, 10 seconds each:

> "One word: how does AI make you feel right now?"

Section 01: Who Are You? (5 minutes)

Survey questions: age, faith, denomination, role, tech comfort, AI tools used

Results (1 minute)

Show 2–3 data points:

- Which AI tools people in the room have used
- Distribution of tech comfort levels
- Range of roles represented (pastors, lay leaders, professionals, etc.)

Discussion (2 minutes)

- "Who's surprised by what people are using?"
- "How many of you use AI tools regularly — and had no idea others in this room did too?"
- "Does comfort with technology predict how you feel about AI in the church?"

Bible Resources (2 minutes)

Participant call: "What scriptures come to mind when you think about tools, craft, or human creativity?"

Facilitator additions:

- **Genesis 4:20-22** — Jubal and Tubal-cain: tool-making as part of human cultural development
- **Exodus 31:1-6** — Bezalel filled with the Spirit for craftsmanship, skill, and knowledge
- **1 Corinthians 10:23** — "All things are lawful, but not all things build up"

Section 02: Where Do You Personally Draw the Line? (8 minutes)

Survey questions: personal spiritual use of AI, faith impact, dependency concern, personal off-limits uses, idolatry potential

Results (2 minutes)

Show 2–3 data points:

- How many use AI in personal spiritual practices (prayer, Bible study, devotions)
- Whether people feel AI has positively or negatively impacted their faith
- What uses people personally consider off-limits (spiritual guidance, emotional support, creative worship, sermon prep)
- Whether people see AI as something with idolatry potential

Discussion (3 minutes)

- "How many of you have felt torn — this is helpful, but something feels off?"
- "Is using AI for prayer or devotions a shortcut, or just a tool? Where is the line?"
- "What would it look like to become spiritually dependent on AI in a way that harms your faith?"
- "If AI has idolatry potential — what does that actually look like in practice?"

Bible Resources (3 minutes)

Participant call: "What scriptures speak to wisdom, personal discipline, or the formation of the inner life?"

Facilitator additions:

- **Psalm 1:1-3** — Meditate on the law day and night; the image of slow, rooted growth
- **Luke 10:38-42** — Mary chose the one necessary thing; the tension of activity vs. presence
- **Proverbs 4:23** — Guard your heart, for everything flows from it
- **Isaiah 44:9-20** — The danger of making something with your hands and then bowing to it
- **Romans 1:25** — Worshipping the created thing rather than the Creator

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Section 03: Where Do We As a Church Draw the Line? (8 minutes)

Survey questions: church use of AI for sermon prep, social media, website, operations/efficiency, disclosure, whether the church has a clear position

Results (2 minutes)

Show the spread of responses on each use case:

- Sermon preparation (Definitely Not → Definitely Yes)
- Social media content
- Website building and maintenance
- Operational efficiency (e.g. attendance counting, admin automation)
- Whether AI use in church should always be disclosed
- Whether this church currently has a clear position on AI

Discussion (3 minutes)

- "Which of these felt obviously fine? Which ones felt obviously wrong? Which ones are you genuinely unsure about?"
- "Is there a difference between AI writing the pastor's sermon and AI counting how many people showed up?"
- "If someone in the congregation doesn't know a post was AI-generated — does that matter? Why?"
- "We asked whether this church has a clear position on AI. What do you think the answer should be?"

Bible Resources (3 minutes)

Participant call: "What scriptures speak to the community of faith, shared discernment, or how we use resources together?"

Facilitator additions:

- **Acts 2:42-47** — The early church: shared life, common purpose, radical transparency
- **1 Corinthians 12:12-26** — The body of Christ: different gifts, shared judgment
- **Nehemiah 4** — Using every available means to rebuild, while remaining vigilant
- **Psalm 127:1** — Unless the Lord builds the house, the builders labour in vain

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Section 04: How Should We Respond? (8 minutes)

Survey questions: who should lead the church's response, formal policy, mass unemployment concern, surveillance resistance

Results (2 minutes)

Show responses on:

- Who people think should lead the church's response (denominations, pastors, tech-literate members, collaboration, personal discernment)
- Whether a formal AI policy or guideline is needed
- Level of concern about AI and mass unemployment
- Whether Christians should speak out against government AI surveillance and social control

Discussion (4 minutes)

- "The data shows [X] think it should be personal discernment, and [X] think we need formal guidance. Can both be right?"
- "Who actually has the credibility to lead this? The most tech-savvy? The most spiritually mature? Both?"
- "AI is already beginning to displace jobs. How does 'love your neighbour' apply when automation puts people out of work?"
- "On surveillance: is a government using AI to monitor citizens a legitimate safety tool, a threat to human dignity, or both? What's the Christian posture?"

Bible Resources (4 minutes)

Participant call: "What scriptures speak to leadership, authority, justice, or how we engage the powers of the world?"

Facilitator additions:

- **Romans 13:1-7** — Governing authorities are established by God; but with limits
- **Acts 5:29** — "We must obey God rather than human beings" — the limits of compliance
- **Micah 6:8** — Do justice, love kindness, walk humbly
- **James 5:1-6** — Warning to the wealthy who exploit workers; God hears the cries of the displaced
- **Jeremiah 29:4-7** — Seek the welfare of the city you are in; engage, don't withdraw
- **Revelation 13:16-17** — The mark of the beast and economic control; surveillance and coercion are not new fears

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Section 05: What Future Do We Want to Create? (8 minutes)

Survey questions: eschatological significance of AI, Tegmark outcome ranking, final open response

Results (2 minutes)

Show:

- How the group answered whether AI has end-times relevance
- The collective ranking of Tegmark's seven possible AI futures (most to least desirable)
- Selected quotes from the open-text responses (anonymized)

Brief context for the room:

> "In *Life 3.0*, Max Tegmark maps seven futures if AGI — AI that can do anything a human intellect can do — ever emerges. Your group ranked which futures they most want. This is what you chose."

Discussion (3 minutes)

- "What does your top-ranked future reveal about what you actually value?"
- "Is AGI a new Tower of Babel — human presumption that will require divine intervention? Or a tool the Church should be ready to steward?"
- "You voted on eschatological relevance. If AI *is* significant for end times — what does that mean for what we do now, this week?"
- "What did the open-text responses say that surprised you?"

Bible Resources (3 minutes)

Participant call: "What scriptures speak to the future, God's sovereignty over history, or how we live in uncertain times?"

Facilitator additions:

- **Genesis 11:1-9** — Babel: humanity unified in purpose, building toward the sky — and God intervened
- **Daniel 2:31-45** — Human kingdoms rise and fall; only one kingdom is eternal
- **Matthew 24:4-8** — Birth pains, deception, the call for discernment
- **Revelation 13:11-18** — The image of the beast; worship coerced through economic and technological power
- **Isaiah 46:9-10** — "I declare the end from the beginning" — God is not surprised by AGI
- **Psalm 2** — The nations rage and plot; God is not threatened

Frame the tension before closing:

> "Some of you see AI as Babel — human overreach that will require divine correction. Others see it as a Pentecost-like tool for gospel spread before Christ returns. Both are in Scripture. The Church has always lived in this tension. You don't have to resolve it tonight."

Closing: What Do We Do With This? (5 minutes)

Transition:

> "We've walked through five sections of data, discussion, and Scripture. Now — what do we actually do?"

Rapid synthesis:

- Each participant writes **one principle** on a card or sticky note
- Read aloud as collected
- **Do not seek consensus** — capture the full range

Examples to spark thinking:

- "AI should amplify, not replace, human relationship in the church"
- "We disclose when AI shapes our communication to the congregation"

- "We consider the economically vulnerable in every AI decision we make"
- "Personal use is personal — corporate use requires shared discernment"

Closing charge:

> "This isn't a finished framework. It's a seed. Take it back to your community. Water it. The Church's voice in this conversation matters — not in ten years. Now."

Facilitator Notes

Hold the tension:

- Do not let the group settle too comfortably in "AI is all bad" or "AI is neutral, just a tool"
- When contradictions arise, name them: "*Both are in the data. Both are in Scripture. What do we do with that?*"

Ground everything in the actual data:

- When someone shares a personal view, redirect: "*Does the data from your group support that? Challenge it?*"
- The survey results are the conversation partner, not just background

Bible is participatory first:

- Always ask participants for scriptures before offering your own
- Add facilitator additions to expand, not to correct or redirect
- Don't proof-text — let Scripture complicate, not just confirm

On questions you can't resolve:

- It is okay to say: "*We're not going to agree on this tonight, and that's okay. Naming the question is the first act of stewardship.*"

Appendix: All Scriptures by Theme

Section	Key Scriptures
01 — Who Are You?	Genesis 4:20-22, Exodus 31:1-6, 1 Corinthians 10:23
02 — Your Personal Line	Psalm 1:1-3, Luke 10:38-42, Proverbs 4:23, Isaiah 44:9-20, Romans 1:25
03 — The Church's Line	Acts 2:42-47, 1 Corinthians 12, Nehemiah 4, Psalm 127:1
04 — How Should We Respond?	Romans 13:1-7, Acts 5:29, Micah 6:8, James 5:1-6, Jeremiah 29:4-7, Revelation 13:16-17
05 — What Future Do We Want?	Genesis 11:1-9, Daniel 2, Matthew 24, Revelation 13:11-18, Isaiah 46:9-10, Psalm 2

Workshop guide for the Technological Stewardship research initiative.